

Esc
clear input /
stop hl

jless graphical cheat sheet

~	!	@	# prev occur of key	\$ end of sibling	% match bracket	^ first sibling	&	* next occur of key	(	)	_	+
`	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	o	-	=
q quit/jq-style path (y q)	w move fwd until depth change	E deep expand e shallow expand	R r	T t	y copy prefix (yy)	U u	I i	O o	p print path (y p)/print cmds	{ [	}]	
A a	s string unescaped (y p)	D d	F f	G jump to line g jump to line	H focus parent h collapse or parent	J next sibling j move down	K prev sibling k up /key name (y k)	L l expand or first child	: command line ; scroll truncated to end	" '	 \	
Z z used in zz, zt, zb	X x	C deep collapse focused c shallow collapse focused	v value one-line (y p)v	b bracket path (y b)/move bwd until depth change	N prev search match n next search match	M m toggle data mode	< decrease indent , scroll truncated left	> increase indent . scroll truncated right	? start backward search / start forward search			

motion

moves the cursor, or defines the range for an operator

command

direct action command

operator

requires a motion afterwards, operates between cursor & destination

extra

special functions, requires extra input

Basic Commands

Count Prefix: Type number N before command to repeat N times (e.g., 3j, 5n, 10k)

Exit: q, Ctrl-C, :quit, :exit

Help: F1 or :help

Data/Line Mode: m toggles between data mode (streamlined) and line mode (pretty JSON)

Match Bracket: % (in line mode) jumps to matching bracket

Special Keys: Home (first line), End (last line), Arrow keys (navigation), Enter (down), Backspace (up), Space (toggle collapse/expand)

Scrolling & View

Page Navigation: Ctrl-f/b (page down/up), Ctrl-d/u (half-page down/up)

Line Scroll: Ctrl-e/y (scroll line down/up), Ctrl-n/p (down/up like j/k)

Center View: zz (center), zt (top), zb (bottom)

Horizontal Scroll: . and , (scroll truncated value right/left), ; (toggle to end/start)

Indent: < and > (decrease/increase indentation)

Search

/pattern: Search forward (count N for Nth occurrence)

?pattern: Search backward

***:** Next occurrence of focused key (# for previous)

n/N: Next/previous match in search direction

Smart Case: Case-insensitive unless pattern has capitals. Add /s for case-sensitive.

Brackets: In patterns, [] {} are literal. Escape with \ for character classes/repetition.

Examples: /[1, 2, 3] matches array; /\[bch\]at matches bat/cat/hat

Copy/Print Commands

y/p prefix: y copies to clipboard, p prints (disables mouse tracking for terminal copy)

yy/pp: Value pretty printed

yv/pv: Value one-line format

ys/ps: String contents unescaped

yk/pk: Key name only

yp/pP: Path (.foo[3].bar)

yb/pb: Bracket path (["foo"][3]["bar"])

yq/pq: jq-style path (.foo[].bar)

Additional Notes

Line Numbers: :set number (absolute), :set relativenumber (relative), :set number! (toggle)

CLI flags: -n/--line-numbers, -r/--relative-line-numbers, --yaml (for YAML files)

Input: jless file.json or cat file.json | jless (handles newline-delimited JSON)

Esc: Clear input buffer / stop highlighting search matches